

add their public key to the server and vice-versa so both can access each other in a secured and authorised manner.

9.2 SSH-agent

Currently in the above scheme there is a small problem, your private key is still left unencrypted, so we have made our operations passwordless, but the private key is still unencrypted, to counter this we will use ssh-agent, which is a program that lets you enter your passphrase only once per session and then decrypts your private key, but stores it only in the memory.

Issue the following in the terminal

```
$ ssh-agent bash
```

Of course if you want a more graphical interface you can do that with the awesomeness of **screen**. If it isn't installed, you can install it as follows:

```
$ sudo apt-get install screen
```

and then you have the option of

```
$ ssh-agent screen.
```

Now you should add your private key(s) with ssh-add:

```
$ ssh-add
```

It will find your ssh keys, and ask for passphrase for each, after a successful operation it will announce via a **Identity added:** message.

So your ssh-agent and your session will last till you keep your terminal window/session open or explicitly close the ssh-agent process. Of course there are many more tricks with ssh, but they are beyond the scope of this introductory guide. So the above introduction to SSH, combined with the skill of shell programming in the Appendix, leaves you with the tools to manipulate in batch even your remote machines.